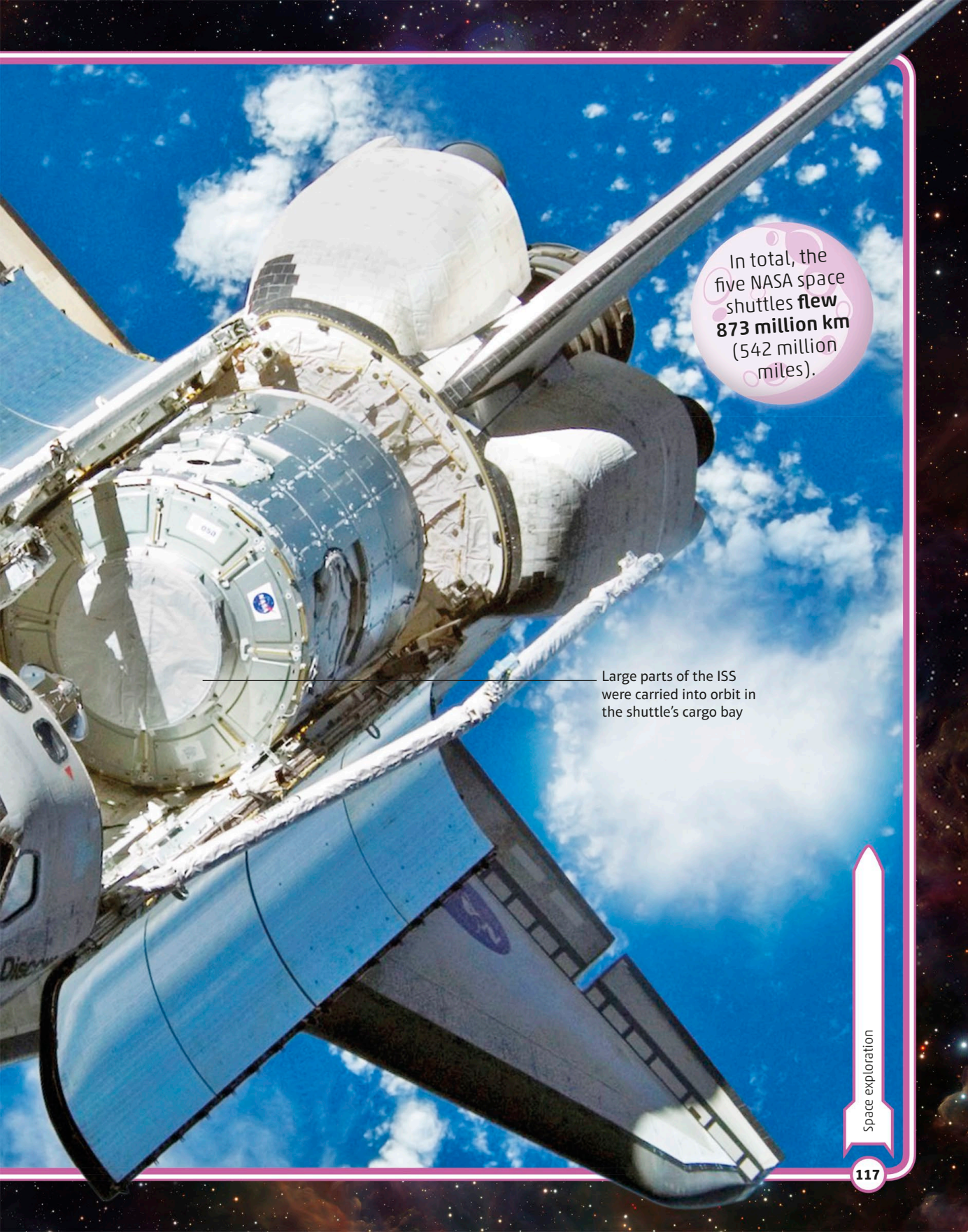


A photograph of the Space Shuttle Columbia in orbit, carrying the International Space Station (ISS) in its cargo bay. The shuttle is seen from a low angle, showing its white orbiter, external tank, and solid rocket boosters. The ISS is a large, complex structure with multiple modules and solar panel arrays. The background is a bright blue sky with white clouds.

In total, the five NASA space shuttles **flew 873 million km** (542 million miles).

Large parts of the ISS were carried into orbit in the shuttle's cargo bay